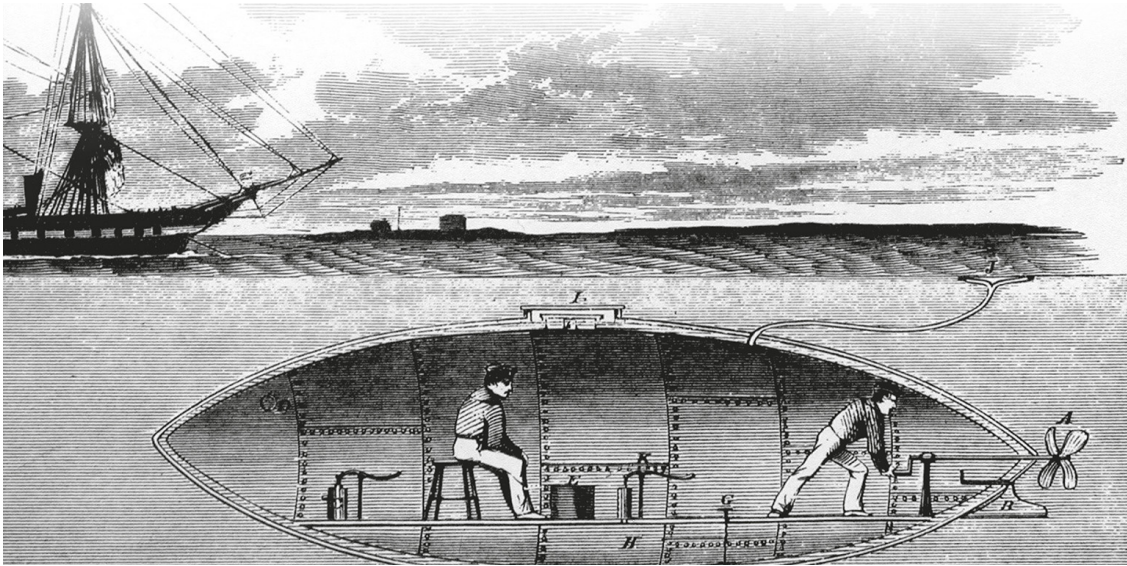


SUBMARINES



The *Hunley* was not the Confederates' first attempt at submarine warfare. In October 1861 they used an unnamed underwater craft, designed by engineer William Cheeney, to try to sink USS *Minnesota* off the Florida coast. The attack failed after the craft became entangled in protective netting around the warship. The Confederates also tested the 30-ft (9-m) *Pioneer*, but scuttled her as Union forces approached New Orleans. On the Union side, the 47-ft (14-m) USS *Alligator* sank in a storm while being towed to her first deployment. Major Edward Hunt designed a one-man "submarine battery," but died of carbon monoxide poisoning while putting her through trials at Brooklyn Navy Yard.